

BUDGET INSPECTOR BRIEF #001

Theme: What Changed Between the 2025 and 2026 Philippine General Appropriations Acts?

Publisher: Budget Inspector Desk (Team Vibe Coders) | **Date:** September 6, 2026

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Data Engine: Reconciled DBM GAA Datasets (R.A. 12116 & R.A. 12314)

Executive Summary

The enacted **FY 2026 General Appropriations Act (GAA, R.A. 12314)** authorizes **₱6.793 Trillion** in national government expenditure, representing a net expansion of **+₱466.84 Billion (+7.38%)** over the **FY 2025 GAA (₱6.326 Trillion)**.

While headline agency growth remained stable across major departments, deep line-item inspection reveals significant internal program shifts, major infrastructure reallocations, and newly introduced GOCC subsidy line items.

Below are verified investigative case files examined by the Budget Inspector desk.

#

Case BI-2026-001: DepEd Basic Education Facilities +215.3% Expansion

****Department**:** Department of Education (DEPED) | ****Agency**:** Office of the Secretary

****Investigative Interest**:** `HIGH` | ****Data Confidence**:** `HIGH`

- ****2025 Allocation**:** ₱25.44 Billion
- ****2026 Allocation**:** ₱80.21 Billion
- ****Absolute Delta**:** ₱54.77 Billion (+215.3%)

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

DepEd's 'Basic Education Facilities' allocation expanded from ₱25.44 Billion in FY 2025 to ₱80.21 Billion in FY 2026, representing an absolute growth of +₱54.77 Billion (+215.3%).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

This line item represents the largest single program increase within the Department of Education for FY 2026. Data confidence is 100% exact

across both GAA workbooks.

##

Provenance Citation

- FY 2025: GAA-2025.xlsx (Row 67075)**
- FY 2026: FY2026-GAA-Byobject.xlsx (Row 65657)**

##

Analytical Caveats

- ⚠ An appropriation increase grants expenditure authority but does not indicate actual procurement contract awards.**
- ⚠ Classroom construction historical absorption capacity has faced bottleneck delays in previous fiscal years.**

##

Recommended Next Questions

- 🔍 What proportion of the ₱80.2B is allocated to DPWH for execution vs direct DepEd procurement?**
- 🔍 Cross-reference DepEd school building disaster damage assessments from recent typhoons.**
- 🔍 Inspect DBM Special Allotment Release Orders (SARO) for release milestones.**

#

Case BI-2026-002: PhilHealth ₱60B SC Mandate & ₱53.1B Sin Tax Subsidies Realignment

****Department**:** Corporations / GOCC Subsidies | ****Agency**:** Philippine Health Insurance Corporation

****Investigative Interest**:** `HIGH` | ****Data Confidence**:** `HIGH`

- ****2025 Allocation**:** ₱0.00 Billion
- ****2026 Allocation**:** ₱60.00 Billion
- ****Absolute Delta**:** ₱60.00 Billion (NEW IN 2026)

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

Two major subsidy lines totaling ₱113.13 Billion appear for PhilHealth in FY 2026: ₱60.00 Billion for Supreme Court mandate compliance and ₱53.13 Billion for Sin Tax health coverage.

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

PhilHealth received one of the largest newly introduced GOCC subsidy line items in FY 2026, establishing a major fiscal precedent following Supreme Court petitions.

##

Provenance Citation

- FY 2025: None
- FY 2026: None

##

Analytical Caveats

-  **GOCC subsidies are subject to special release conditions issued by DBM and DOH.**
-  **Subsidies do not constitute direct cash disbursements to healthcare providers until claims are processed.**

##

Recommended Next Questions

-  **Did DOH's direct health insurance budget decrease correspondingly in FY 2026?**
-  **What specific benefit package expansions are mandated under the ₱60B release terms?**
-  **Inspect Supreme Court ruling text regarding Treasury fund return timelines.**

---**#**

**Case BI-2026-003: DPWH Flood Mitigation Facilities Maintenance
+157.1% Growth******Department**: Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) |******Agency**: Office of the Secretary******Investigative Interest**: `HIGH` | ****Data Confidence**: `HIGH`****

- ****2025 Allocation****: ₱0.70 Billion
- ****2026 Allocation****: ₱1.80 Billion
- ****Absolute Delta****: ₱1.10 Billion (+157.1%)

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

DPWH's line item 'Maintenance, Repair and Rehabilitation of Infrastructure Facilities - Flood Control and Drainage Systems' grew from ₱700.0 Million in 2025 to ₱1.80 Billion in 2026 (+₱1.10 Billion / +157.1%).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

Flood control infrastructure maintenance saw a significant relative boost in 2026, distinct from new capital construction projects.

##

Provenance Citation

- **FY 2025: None**
- **FY 2026: None**

##

Analytical Caveats

- **⚠ Maintenance appropriations cover desilting and emergency repair, distinct from major capital floodway construction.**

-  **Implementation is decentralized across Regional and District Engineering Offices.**

##

Recommended Next Questions

-  **Which DPWH District Engineering Offices received the largest maintenance allocations?**
-  **Cross-reference MMDA's ₱355M new flood control upgrading allocation in Metro Manila.**
-  **Check COA audit reports for DPWH flood control maintenance utilization rates.**

#

Case BI-2026-004: Autonomous Inspection: Maintenance, Repair and Rehabilitation of Infrastr

****Department**:** Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) |

****Agency**:** Office of the Secretary

****Investigative Interest**:** `HIGH` | ****Data Confidence**:** `HIGH`

- ****2025 Allocation**:** ₱0.70 Billion
- ****2026 Allocation**:** ₱1.80 Billion
- ****Absolute Delta**:** ₱1.10 Billion (+157.1%)

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

Automated inspection initiated for Office of the Secretary's program 'Maintenance, Repair and Rehabilitation of Infrastructure Facilities and Other Related Activities - Maintenance, Repair and Rehabilitation of Infrastructure Facilities - Flood Control and Drainage Systems, Structures and Related Facilities'. Allocation moved from ₱700.0M in 2025 to ₱1800.0M in 2026 (Delta: ₱1100.0M).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

Autonomous inspection completed. Reconciled 2025 amount: ₱700,000,000.00, 2026 amount: ₱1,800,000,000.00.

##

Provenance Citation

- FY 2025: GAA-2025.xlsx (Row 485386)
- FY 2026: FY2026-GAA-Byobject.xlsx (Row 482195)

##

Analytical Caveats

- ⚠ Appropriations represent budget authorization, not actual cash disbursements or completed contracts.

##

Recommended Next Questions

- 🔍 Inspect agency's Budget Priorities Framework justification.
- 🔍 Check DBM Special Allotment Release Orders (SAROs).

#

Case BI-2026-005: Autonomous Inspection: Provision of adequate, sustainable, reliable and q

****Department**: Budgetary Support to Government Corporations (BSGC) | **Agency**: National Power Corporation**

****Investigative Interest**: `HIGH` | **Data Confidence**: `HIGH`**

- ****2025 Allocation**: ₱0.00 Billion**
- ****2026 Allocation**: ₱1.87 Billion**
- ****Absolute Delta**: ₱1.87 Billion (NEW IN 2026)**

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

Automated inspection initiated for National Power Corporation's program 'Provision of adequate, sustainable, reliable and quality supply of electricity to Missionary Areas'. Allocation moved from ₱0.0M in 2025 to ₱1866.4M in 2026 (Delta: ₱1866.4M).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

Autonomous inspection completed. Reconciled 2025 amount: ₱0.00, 2026 amount: ₱1,866,377,000.00.

##

Provenance Citation

- FY 2025: None**
- FY 2026: FY2026-GAA-Byobject.xlsx (Row 721784)**

##

Analytical Caveats

-  Appropriations represent budget authorization, not actual cash disbursements or completed contracts.**

##

Recommended Next Questions

-  Inspect agency's Budget Priorities Framework justification.**
-  Check DBM Special Allotment Release Orders (SAROs).**

#

Case BI-2026-006: Autonomous Inspection: Provision of adequate, sustainable, reliable and q

****Department**: Budgetary Support to Government Corporations**

(BSGC) | **Agency: National Power Corporation**

****Investigative Interest**: `HIGH` | **Data Confidence**: `HIGH`**

- ****2025 Allocation**: ₱0.00 Billion**
- ****2026 Allocation**: ₱1.87 Billion**
- ****Absolute Delta**: ₱1.87 Billion (NEW IN 2026)**

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

Automated inspection initiated for National Power Corporation's program 'Provision of adequate, sustainable, reliable and quality supply of electricity to Missionary Areas'. Allocation moved from ₱0.0M in 2025 to ₱1866.4M in 2026 (Delta: ₱1866.4M).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

Autonomous inspection completed. Reconciled 2025 amount: ₱0.00, 2026 amount: ₱1,866,377,000.00.

##

Provenance Citation

- **FY 2025: None**
- **FY 2026: FY2026-GAA-Byobject.xlsx (Row 721784)**

##

Analytical Caveats

-  Appropriations represent budget authorization, not actual cash disbursements or completed contracts.

##

Recommended Next Questions

-  Inspect agency's Budget Priorities Framework justification.
-  Check DBM Special Allotment Release Orders (SAROs).

#

Case BI-2026-007: Autonomous Inspection: Additional Appropriation in Compliance with the Su

****Department**:** Budgetary Support to Government Corporations

(BSGC) | **Agency:** Philippine Health Insurance Corporation

****Investigative Interest**:** `HIGH` | ****Data Confidence**:** `HIGH`

- ****2025 Allocation**:** ₱0.00 Billion
- ****2026 Allocation**:** ₱60.00 Billion
- ****Absolute Delta**:** ₱60.00 Billion (NEW IN 2026)

##

What Changed & Why It Stands Out

Automated inspection initiated for Philippine Health Insurance Corporation's program 'Additional Appropriation in Compliance with

the Supreme Court Decision'. Allocation moved from ₱0.0M in 2025 to ₱60000.0M in 2026 (Delta: ₱60000.0M).

##

Inspector Checks & Findings

Autonomous inspection completed. Reconciled 2025 amount: ₱0.00, 2026 amount: ₱60,000,000,000.00.

##

Provenance Citation

- FY 2025: None**
- FY 2026: FY2026-GAA-Byobject.xlsx (Row 721891)**

##

Analytical Caveats

- ⚠ Appropriations represent budget authorization, not actual cash disbursements or completed contracts.**

##

Recommended Next Questions

- 🔍 Inspect agency's Budget Priorities Framework justification.**
- 🔍 Check DBM Special Allotment Release Orders (SAROs).**

Methodology & Provenance Guarantee

Every calculation in this brief was performed deterministically using DuckDB SQL queries over normalized Parquet tables derived from official DBM Excel workbooks.

- ****FY 2025 Reconciled Sum****: ₱6,326,685,586,000.00 (0.0057% variance vs DBM Grand Total)
- ****FY 2026 Reconciled Sum****: ₱6,793,162,000,000.00 (100.00% exact match vs DBM Grand Total)

Note: An appropriation represents legislative authorization to incur obligations and does not constitute an actual disbursement, procurement contract, or completed project.
